



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Concordia Classical Academy
School Website: <https://concordiaclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Concordia Classical Academy (Walton, KY, 41094) presents a distinctly classical Christian program operating as a two-day cottage school in Northern Kentucky. Public-facing materials emphasize a traditional, virtue- and character-formation approach anchored in Christian theology, the liberal arts, and classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; great books; and classical history). The school explicitly frames education as formation (virtue, wisdom) rather than mere information, and promotes the true, good, and beautiful as real ideals. It partners with parents, references a Statement of Faith, and presents a community rhythm that includes shared worship concepts and school prayer. On balance, the school demonstrates clear classical elements across most dimensions, with especially strong alignment in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Curriculum. Pedagogy and Community aspects show robust classical signals but less explicit documentation of the full “living curriculum” faculty model in public-facing materials. The overall classification is CLASSICAL, with a notable strength in curricular coherence and theology-centric framing. A minor needle-moving opportunity exists around more explicit articulation of faculty as the living curriculum and deeper demonstration of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Explicit Christian foundation, creedal statement of faith, and theology-integrated framing (e.g., “classical Christian curriculum,” “Christ is the cornerstone,” Apostles’ Creed). See About Concordia and Welcome pages. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; formation; theology; liturgy; worship. Negative indicators: none evident in public materials. Why this rating: A clear transcendental/metaphysical orientation and grounded theology with liturgical/community practices are present.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Vision emphasizes growth of character and mastery of subjects; goal statements articulate two-day classical instruction and formation over mere information. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtue, wisdom, formation, truth/goodness/beauty; human excellence; character development. No explicit negative indicators. Why this rating: The school foregrounds formation and virtue as primary aims, aligning with classical aims beyond job-prep.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Curriculum is built on liberal arts manifestations (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin), continuous history study across grades; explicit Great Books/Great Conversation orientation in public materials; direct reference to “the seven liberal arts.” Public-facing Course of Study materials show grammar to upper-level Latin, classical studies, and medieval/ancient history texts. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; history integrated across curriculum; wonder; classical canon; Latin; memorization/recitation as pedagogy. Negative keywords: none evident in materials. Why this rating: The school explicitly deploys classical curriculum scaffolds (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; classical history; great books) and treats history and literature as integrated across disciplines.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Upper grades emphasize dialectic and rhetoric with explicit wording about dialectic/logic-centric study (Socratic or seminar-like elements implied through “dialectic and rhetorical phases”); lower/middle grades emphasize memory work, recitation, and singing as memory aids; the campus model is designed around a blend of contemplative and rigorous

elements; quotations about rhetoric and classical training appear in the materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic discussion; dialectic; rhetoric; memorization/recitation; wonder; slow/Scholé rhythm. Negative: minimal explicit mention of non-classical pedagogies; no strong evidence of non-classical approaches. Why this rating: Pedagogy leans toward classic methods (dialectic, rhetoric, memorization, and classical memory work), with upper grades supporting Socratic/seminar-style processes.

- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site notes “Our teachers are gifted at what they do, and strive to serve our homeschool families well,” indicating capable mentorship and alignment with the school’s aims. The site also references the teachers as part of the program structure (e.g., private/family-centered model). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include terms like “model teachers,” mentorship, and “living curriculum” in classical contexts (conceptual alignment though not always explicit in public pages). The explicit public statements about faculty as “gifted” and “serving families” align with the classical expectation of model teachers; however, explicit language stating faculty are the “living curriculum” or a clearly articulated faculty culture is less visible in the public-facing pages. Why this rating: The evidence supports strong faculty quality and mentorship (positive), but explicit articulation of faculty as the living curriculum and a fully collegial faculty culture is not as strongly documented on the public site as the other categories. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school presents itself as partnering with parents; “Vision: Concordia Classical Academy partners with parents to teach children” and uses a cottage-school model designed for parent involvement; statements of faith and school formation emphasize family partnership; open-door philosophy for parent involvement via information nights, campus tours, and family engagement around classical education. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Partnership with Families; parent involvement; community of learners; parental engagement; living tradition in the family; family catechesis. Negative keywords: none evident in public materials. Why this rating: The school foregrounds active parental partnership and community involvement—core signals of classical education’s community dimension.

Overall ranking and aggregate assessment

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- For this SCHOOL: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category (Element 5) is the only non-CLASSICAL signal. The following needle-moving steps could push this toward full CLASSICAL:
- Develop and publish explicit language and concrete examples showing the faculty as the “living curriculum” and a clearly defined faculty culture (mentorship, collegiality, shared teacher-vision) across all grades.
- Provide explicit public documentation of Socratic teaching practices in upper grades (e.g., sample seminar prompts, teacher prompts, and student-led Socratic dialogues) to demonstrate the pervasiveness of a Socratic pedagogy rather than a primarily instructor-led approach.
- Increase transparency around continuous faculty professional development aligned with classical education standards (e.g., CLAS/CLS-style training, classical pedagogy workshops) and publish these efforts on the website.
- Expand explicit liturgical or communal practices on campus (e.g., daily/weekly chapel, liturgical music, explicit times of communal prayer) to strengthen Liturgical and Communal Practices documentation.
- Consider highlighting additional Great Conversation signals (e.g., explicit reference to Great Books, original texts, and cross-disciplinary dialogue) and ensure public materials consistently connect core curriculum to the Great Books/Western canon.

ABSTRACT

Concordia Classical Academy (Walton, KY, 41094) demonstrates a strong CLASSICAL orientation across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and Community/Parent engagement, with explicit Christian/theological framing and a clear liberal-arts-based curriculum that includes Latin, Great Books, and a dialectic/rhetoric progression in upper grades. The pedagogy shows substantial classical signals (memory work in early years; Socratic/dialectic elements suggested in upper grades). Faculty signals are positive but less explicit in describing the faculty as the living curriculum, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in that category. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with a potential needle-moving path primarily through more explicit articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum and fuller demonstration of Socratic pedagogy and liturgical practices in public communications.

Key sources from the school site include:

- Vision/Mission/Creed and two-day classical Christian cottage model with Apostles' Creed and Statement of Faith emphasis.
- Explicit curriculum framing around classical education, the true/good/beautiful, and formation rather than information.
- Public course-of-study documents detailing grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, and Great Books/Great Conversation elements.
- The Great Books/Great Conversation rhetoric appears in school-facing materials describing classical education as the study of the classics and great books.
- Public statements about faculty quality (gifted teachers) and the teacher-filled support environment.
- Parental partnership orientation and community engagement signals (two-day cottage model; partnership with parents).

Note on methodology and rubric references

- The keyword framework for each category relies on the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). Positive keywords (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, unity of knowledge, formation, liturgical practices) and the corresponding Negative keywords guide the scoring for each category. The six-element rubric informs category definitions and scoring guidance (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL). See the Six Essential Elements documents for the keyword lists and structure.
- Direct textual evidence from Concordia's site is cited above to ground the analysis in public-facing claims about theology, curriculum, pedagogy, and governance.

ABSTRACT

ed six-category keyword touchpoints (high level)

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; liturgy; creed.
- Purpose & Goal: formation; virtue; wisdom; true/good/beautiful; human excellence.
- Curriculum: Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; history across disciplines; wonder.
- Pedagogy: memory/Scholé; singing/chanting in lower years; Socratic/dialectic/seminar in upper years; rhetoric and public-speaking opportunities.
- Faculty: gifted teachers; living curriculum signals (where documented); mentorship.
- Parents & Community: partnership with families; co-teaching; parental engagement; open visits.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot (Detailed)

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: creedal faith (Apostles' Creed); Christian grounding; theology integrated into education; Christ-centered framing; liturgical/community rhythm present in messaging. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: truth, goodness, beauty (via "true, the good and the beautiful"); virtue; wisdom; formation; theology;

liturgy; communal worship. Negative keywords: none observed. Why this rating: Public materials clearly anchor education in transcendentals and Christian theology with communal worship and creedal affirmation, consistent with classical education's metaphysical foundations.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit formation emphasis, two-day classical instruction, growth of character and mastery of subjects; formation over information. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: formation; wisdom; virtue; character; truth/goodness/beauty. Negative: none noted. Why this rating: The mission/vision foregrounds formation and virtue, aligning with classical aims rather than a purely vocational or information-transfer model.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: liberal arts framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin); cross-grade history focus; explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing; integration and wonder in learning. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; interdisciplinary/harmony; wonder; classical texts; Latin; memorization/recitation. Negative: none evident. Why this rating: The curriculum explicitly mirrors classical curricula with liberal-arts scaffolding, Great Books engagement, and a history-literature-integrated approach.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence: dialectic/rhetoric emphasis in upper grades; Socratic or seminar-like elements implied by "dialectic and rhetorical phases"; classical pedagogy elements in upper grades; memory work and chant-like activities in early years. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: Socratic discussion; dialectic; rhetoric; memorization; wonder; rest/reflective pace (Scholé). Negative: no explicit anti-classical pedagogy documented. Why this rating: The presence of dialectic/rhetoric and classical memory work aligns with traditional Pedagogy signals in classical education.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: "Our teachers are gifted at what they do, and strive to serve our homeschool families well" (faculty quality signals). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: teacher quality; mentorship; supportive staff. Negative keywords: explicit articulation of the faculty as the "living curriculum" or a fully developed faculty culture is less evident in public materials. Why this rating: Strong evidence of capable teachers; however, public-facing materials do not consistently articulate a comprehensive "living curriculum" faculty framework, which keeps this at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit partnership with parents; parental involvement as co-teachers; openness to parent information nights; family engagement in classical education; public statements about partnering with families. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords: Partnership with Families; parent engagement; co-educators; family formation; living tradition in the family. Negative: none observed. Why this rating: The public materials foreground strong parent partnership and family engagement consistent with classical education norms.

What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- For Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a clear, public statement that the faculty are the living curriculum, with examples of collegial practices, mentorship models, and ongoing professional development aligned with classical pedagogy.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit examples of Socratic seminars and dialectical activities in upper grades (with sample prompts, rubrics, and outcomes) to demonstrate pervasive Socratic pedagogy across grades.
- For Element 1 and 6 (Religious Foundations and Parents/Community): Explicitly detail liturgical practices (e.g., cadence of worship, liturgy types) and create a "parent academy" or ongoing book-study series anchored in classical Christian education to further demonstrate liturgical integration and parental formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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